

# How can I help ai be more sustainable?

Posted by u/AmazingSkater • 0 points • 16 comments

Generative AI such as ChatGPT uses water and energy, and emits CO2. Search engines like google and bing now have ai overview answers with every search. The ai overview helps me find out answers quickly, but I am concerned about the negative environmental impacts of generative ai.

I can't stop searching things on the internet because I want to know things.

Realistically, how can I help reduce my environmental impact and/or contribute to the development of more sustainable ai?

## Comments

u/regprenticer • 1 points • 2025-05-03 07:34 UTC

A very simple answer to this would be for Google to provide a way to exclude the AI response from "vanilla" search results, either as part of your chrome settings, or as a text element of the prompt.

u/SilverMammoth7856 • 1 points • 2025-05-02 09:52 UTC

Use AI tools only when they truly add value-skip unnecessary queries and prefer traditional search or direct sources for simple questions.

Support and advocate for AI companies to use renewable energy, improve model efficiency, and increase transparency about their environmental impact

u/Global\_Gas\_6441 • 1 points • 2025-05-02 09:41 UTC

PLEASE STOP

u/AmazingSkater • 1 points • 2025-05-03 02:11 UTC

Why

u/Reddit\_wander01 • 1 points • 2025-05-02 00:02 UTC

Get your local data center to convert to hydrogen fuel cells for power..

<https://www.plugpower.com/blog/hydrogen-fuel-cells-in-data-centers-a-clean-energy-revolution/>

u/Dapht1 • 1 points • 2025-05-01 21:46 UTC

Nuclear power.

u/Soggy-Apple-3704 • 2 points • 2025-05-01 21:35 UTC

I think it will get better as it matures. Companies will be competing who will make it cheaper (which often means more ecologic).

**u/DarthArchon** • 2 points • 2025-05-01 21:26 UTC

Don't say thank you

**u/PhantomJaguar** • 1 points • 2025-05-01 20:56 UTC

Try using local models like Gwen3. They're good enough for most stuff and won't boil any dolphins.

You can save heavier models like ChatGPT for stuff that's actually important so the effort isn't wasted.

**u/HarmadeusZex** • 7 points • 2025-05-01 19:41 UTC

Can you stop writing nonsense, it emits CO2

**u/[deleted]** • 1 points • 2025-05-01 19:20 UTC

[removed]

**u/AcceptableArm8841** • 1 points • 2025-05-01 19:14 UTC

No, it just uses electricity. That's it. The anti AI crazies have been using the shotgun approach when it comes to their arguments. They just say that it's bad because... and then they make up all kinds of stuff.

**u/meagainpansy** • 2 points • 2025-05-01 20:28 UTC

I work in the field. It does use absurd amounts of power, and a roughly equal amount of power for cooling.

**u/AcceptableArm8841** • 1 points • 2025-05-01 21:11 UTC

Thanks for backing up what I said! Thanks!

**u/meagainpansy** • 3 points • 2025-05-01 21:59 UTC

No, my point was "it just uses electricity" is an understatement.

**u/reddit455** • 2 points • 2025-05-01 19:04 UTC

>Generative AI such as ChatGPT

AI is more than an app on a phone.. or search results

> Realistically, how can I help reduce my environmental impact and/or contribute to the development of more sustainable ai?

\*\*\*you\*\*\* can't unless you have a background in that kind of thing....

maybe another AI figures out more efficient ways of doing things. maybe AI just rules things out. things that a human might "waste" time on.. when the figure out it's a dead end.

\*\*Accelerating materials discovery using artificial intelligence, high performance computing and robotics\*\*

[<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41524-022-00765-z>](<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41524-022-00765-z>)

00765-z)

**\*\*Four ways AI is making the power grid faster and more resilient\*\***

[<https://www.technologyreview.com/2023/11/22/1083792/ai-power-grid-improvement/>]  
(<https://www.technologyreview.com/2023/11/22/1083792/ai-power-grid-improvement/>)

**u/AutoModerator** • 1 points • 2025-05-01 18:58 UTC

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**###** Question Discussion Guidelines

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Please use the following guidelines in current and future posts:

- \* Post must be greater than 100 characters - the more detail, the better.
- \* Your question might already have been answered. Use the search feature if no one is engaging in your post.
- \* AI is going to take our jobs - its been asked a lot!
- \* Discussion regarding positives and negatives about AI are allowed and encouraged. Just be respectful.
- \* Please provide links to back up your arguments.
- \* No stupid questions, unless its about AI being the beast who brings the end-times. It's not.

**#####** Thanks - please let mods know if you have any questions / comments / etc

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